



KiCad EDA software suite

best in terms of his knowledge to fit into an EDA job."

Broadly, career in EDA tool design can be divided into front-end and back-end roles.

Panicker explains, "Those who want to take up a front-end career should explore a little bit of the architectural standpoint. Let's suppose he or she wants to design a micro-processor. They should scale up a bit to understand the architecture. Those who are doing the backend need not understand the architecture. For them, the domain shifts a bit from that standpoint. Whether you handle the front-end or back-end, there are immense opportunities in India."

You have to clear tests, sometimes several stages of tests, to reach this stage. Pathak explains: "Cadence has a three-tier process which involves written exam, analytical exam and interviews. I think the degree of complexity of problems during the examination helps us filter the right kind of people. The criteria are very rigid."

Moving up the ladder

An EDA engineer begins his career as a software engineer and can choose between two verticals for growth: technical and managerial. In the hardcore technical space, he becomes

an individual contributor and reaches up to the level of an architect. An architect is someone who conceptualises and shows directions to an organisation as to how it should think about its products and helps in drawing out a vision.

The managerial role is a combination of technical and managerial skills. Here one gets the opportunity to lead projects and people.

If you want customer interactions as well, you can go for applications engineering.

It is worth mentioning here that every company has different job titles. Cadence is a ten-level organisation. Level 1 is where the engineers start from and Level 10 is where they can head the company too.

As far as pay packages are concerned, it's a niche industry in this respect too. EDA being all about qualitative work, pay packages ought to be high in this industry. For beginners, the package can range from Rs 600,000 to Rs 900,000. Of course, it varies from company to company, and includes both graduates and postgraduates. Obviously, a differential is maintained between plain B.Tech candidates and B.Tech with M.Tech candidates. ●

The author is an assistant editor at EYF

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